

DECODED EXPLAINED

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How should RUPPs be regulated ?

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Why do some RUPPs remain active despite poor compliance? How can their misuse be curbed? What can be done to improve transparency? Should RUPPs face a vote threshold for tax breaks? How can the EC act against non-serious parties?

EXPLAINER

Rangarajan R.

The story so far:

A BBC News Hindi investigation has revealed that six Registered Unrecognised Political Parties (RUPPs), all based in Gujarat, had received donations of around ₹1,700 crores for the year 2023-24. This is higher than the total received by five nationally recognised political parties, except the BJP, for the same period, which stood at ₹1,480 crores.

What are registered parties?

Political parties are an association or body of individuals that can be formed by citizens. Section 29A of the Representation of the People Act, 1951 (RP Act) lays down the requirements for registration of a political party with the Election Commission (EC). After satisfactory scrutiny of the documents submitted, the EC registers a political party as a RUPP. The RUPPs enjoy the following benefits – (a) tax exemption for donations received under Section 12 of the Income Tax Act, 2025, (b) common symbol for contesting general elections to the Lok Sabha/State Assemblies, and (c) 20 'star campaigners' during election campaign. The RUPPs are required to maintain the details of individual donors above twenty thousand rupees in a financial year and submit them to the poll body every year. As per section 29C of the Representation of the People Act, failure to furnish these details will result in losing income tax exemption.

The RUPPs, under the Income Tax Act, 2025, are required to accept donations in excess of two thousand rupees only through cheque or bank transfers.

What are the issues?

As per the EC notification, India had more than 2,800 RUPPs as of July, but only around 750 contested the 2024 general elections. This has resulted in the moniker – 'letter pad parties' – for the rest of the RUPPs. The RP Act does not



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confer explicit powers on the EC to de-register a political party if it fails to contest elections, conduct inner-party elections, or lodge requisite returns. In the *Indian National Congress vs Institute of Social Welfare & Ors* (2002), the Supreme Court held that the EC does not have the power to de-register any political party under the RP Act. It may de-register only under exceptional circumstances, such as registration obtained by fraud, the political party ceasing to have allegiance to the Constitution, or being declared unlawful by the government. The EC periodically publishes the list of de-listed RUPPs. The October 2025 notification contains over 800 such parties.

However, the six RUPPs – Aam Janmat Party, Bharatiya National Janata Dal, Garib Kalyan Party, New India United Party, Satyawadi Rakshak Party and the Swatantrata Abhiyaad Party – remain on the list of active RUPPs as per the EC notification in October 2025. This is because they managed to field a total of 15 candidates during the 2024 Lok Sabha elections. The Association for Democratic

Reforms periodically publishes reports on the status of submission of annual reports of RUPPs. In its July 2025 report, in which the annual reports of 2022-23 are analysed, it is stated that reports of only 26% of RUPPs are available in the public domain. Poor compliance with statutory requirements, coupled with a lack of transparency, results in these 'letter pad' parties being used as an opaque channel for tax evasion and money laundering.

What needs to be done?

The Law Commission, in its 255th report, had recommended amendments for de-registration of a political party if it fails to contest elections for ten consecutive years. The EC, in its memorandum for electoral reforms (2016), also suggested an amendment to the RP Act that would empower it to de-register a party. These are long-pending reforms that need to be carried out to empower the EC to act against non-serious parties, some of which are merely a façade for illegal financial transactions.

However, if parties contest elections

merely to fulfil a statutory requirement, they could continue to misuse their tax exemptions and be used for money laundering and other nefarious activities. In the present digital world, it is not difficult for the Income Tax Department and other enforcement agencies to monitor the transactions of such parties and take strict action against any wrongdoing. This would act as a deterrent against the misuse of the benefits and exemptions available to political parties.

The EC had also suggested that tax exemptions be provided only for political parties that win seats in Lok Sabha or Legislative Assembly elections. This can be viewed as an undemocratic and extreme measure, as there are parties that consistently contest elections without electoral success. Instead, similar to the 1% vote threshold for allotting common symbols to RUPPs, a suitable vote percentage threshold may be stipulated by law for RUPPs to avail of tax exemptions on donations received. (Rangarajan R. is a former IAS officer. Views expressed are personal)

THE GIST

▼ Six Gujarat-based RUPPs received about ₹1,700 crore in donations in 2023-24, raising concerns over opaque political funding

▼ Weak statutory provisions and poor compliance allow many non-serious RUPPs to remain active and potentially misuse tax exemptions

▼ The EC needs stronger powers to de-register such parties, while a suitable vote threshold could determine eligibility for tax exemptions

How should RUPPs be regulated ?

Political parties are registered under the Section 29A of RPA, 1951 and considers as RUPP (Registered Unrecognised political party)

Benefits of RUPP

- Tax exemption under Income Tax Act

- common symbol for contesting general elections to the Lok Sabha/State Assemblies (no reserved symbol)

- 20 'star campaigners' during election campaign.

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Context :

'BBC News Hindi investigation has revealed that six Registered Unrecognised Political Parties (RUPP), all based in Gujarat, had received donations of around R1,700 crores for the year 2023-24. This is higher than the total received by five nationally recognised political parties, except the BJP, for the same period, which stood at R1,480

Way ahead

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Fresh Green Card hurdle: What's the PERM system targeted by US

Soumyarendra Barik
New Delhi, September 10

THE US Department of Labor on September 8 suspended IT services giant Cognizant's filings under PERM, a key system used by American employers to sponsor foreign workers for permanent residency, as authorities investigate alleged fraud and misuse of employment-based immigration programmes. Similar action was announced against software company Cloud-era. US authorities have not yet disclosed the specific allegations against Cognizant, the number of applications affected or the duration of the suspension.

The action comes amid a broader crack-down by the Donald Trump administration on employment-based immigration, with technology and IT services companies facing scrutiny over reliance on foreign workers.

US authorities have stepped up investigations into claims of wage undercutting, fraudulent filings and displacement of American workers. The scrutiny is significant for Indian professionals, who account

for a large share of H-1B beneficiaries and employment-based Green Card applicants.

What is PERM?

PERM, or Program Electronic Review Management, is the system through which employers obtain labour certification before sponsoring a foreign employee for an employment-based Green Card. Unlike a visa application, which is primarily made by an individual, the PERM filing is done by the employer on behalf of the worker.

Before filing, an employer must obtain a prevailing wage determination for the position and carry out prescribed recruitment. Broadly, the process is intended to establish that hiring a foreign worker permanently will not adversely affect the job opportunities, wages or working conditions of US workers. Once the Labour Department certifies the application, the employer can proceed to the next stage of the Green Card process. The date on which the Labour Department accepts the labour certification application also generally becomes the worker's "priority date", which is effectively

Cognizant under lens

- US-headquartered Cognizant had 3,56,700 employees globally as of June 2026. At 2025-end, over 2,50,000 of its employees were based in India.

- This does not mean all of them are affected by the US action. But Cognizant's large Indian employee base and its longstanding use of US employment-based immigration routes mean Indians are likely to make up a significant share of those affected.

their place in the queue for an employment-based immigrant visa.

How is it different from H-1B?

An H-1B is a temporary, non-immigrant work visa that allows US employers to employ foreign professionals in speciality occupations. PERM, in contrast, is part of the process to obtain permanent residency.

The two can, therefore, run alongside. An Indian, for instance, could be working for Cognizant in the US on an H-1B visa while the company separately files a PERM application to sponsor the employee for a Green Card. A PERM suspension, on its own, does not cancel an employee's existing H-1B status or an already-issued Green Card.

How will Indian workers be affected?

For Cognizant employees whose Green Card process has not yet reached the PERM filing stage, the immediate consequence is a delay. Cognizant cannot make fresh PERM filings now, meaning affected employees cannot secure a priority date and begin moving through the employer-spon-

sored Green Card process.

That can be particularly consequential for Indians because they already face a severe backlog. In the US State Department's September 2026 Visa Bulletin, the employment-based second preference, or EB-2, category for India was listed as "unavailable" for final action, while the EB-3 final action date was January 1, 2014. The system also imposes limits on the number of employment-based Green Cards available to nationals of any one country.

There can also be an H-1B implication for some workers approaching the normal six-year limit on that visa. US rules allow certain H-1B holders to extend their stay beyond six years where a labour certification was filed sufficiently early. An inability to get the PERM process started could therefore become more serious for employees nearing that deadline. Workers who already have approved petitions and are waiting because a Green Card number is unavailable are in a different position and can, subject to the rules, qualify for H-1B extensions of up to three years at a time.

Fresh Green Card hurdle

PERM, or Program Electronic Review Management, is a system through which US employers generally obtain labour certification before sponsoring a foreign worker for an employment-based Green Card. The process seeks to ensure that employing a foreign worker permanently does not adversely affect the jobs, wages and working conditions of US workers.

The H-1B is a temporary, non-immigrant work visa that allows US employers to employ foreign professionals in speciality occupations.

PERM, in contrast, is part of the process through which an employer seeks permanent residency for a foreign worker.

The H-1B therefore provides a temporary employment pathway, whereas PERM facilitates the transition towards an employment-based Green Card.

Should the use of Gen AI be banned among younger students in school

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Lavina Jaswani
Founder of the
Sprouts
International
School in Jaipur



Deepa Jacob
Class 5 teacher
at the American
International
School in Chennai

PARLEY

Recently, New York City Mayor Zohran Mamdani announced a one-year moratorium on most generative AI tools for public school students until Class 8 for the 2026/27 academic year. Officials argued that young children require human connection and independent problem-solving skills instead of relying on algorithms. India's policies on this issue are still evolving. So, should the use of Gen AI be banned among younger students in schools? Lavina Jaswani and Deepa Jacob discuss this question in a conversation moderated by Priscilla Jeyaraj.

What kind of AI tools do you use and how do they benefit primary school children?

Lavina Jaswani: We have been using a number of AI-enabled tools to explain concepts to children, to offer personalised learning and to help teachers create resources, from stories and worksheets to different types of assessments and quizzes. There are different apps we use, such as Kahoot! and Quizlets, to offer a gamified, interactive, and sensorial learning experience that keeps children engaged, rather than the traditional rote learning method.

However, the teacher still has to ask herself, what is my learning objective? What does a child need to understand? Where can the technology add value and is it truly beneficial and essential for the child? Keeping such questions in mind, AI tools can be effectively used in the classroom.

Deepa Jacob: In our school, technology is integrated seamlessly into our teaching and learning experience. Every child from kindergarten onwards has access to a tablet, which is kept at the school, they don't take them home. They have apps that might be able to assist them with learning such as Seesaw, which is a journal of their learning through which they can keep a record of things that they do, like published writing pieces, videos of science experiments, their reflection on their learning etc. You can even assign tasks on them!

Very recently, I discovered that Seesaw itself has an AI component. So, for example, we do a lot of work with reading fluency. The kids are given a grade-level passage. They do a cold read of it on day one and through the week they reread the passage along with the teacher, and learn to pronounce the words, the meaning of the words, and then finally on day five they record their reading again and they find that they've improved in their fluency and their accuracy. Recently, one of my colleagues found out that the recording feature has an AI component which transcribes what you've said and scores you based on your accuracy. This is really great because rather than the teacher having to listen to every child read, if an app can score your reading and tell you which words you



New frontier: India's first AI teacher '161' interacts with students at a school, in Attingal, in Thiruvananthapuram, in 2024. (PI)

are reading incorrectly, then you can practise those words alone. But it's AI, not a person, so it comes with its own flaws. For example, one of my students was reading a word with an Indian accent, and the app marked it as wrong. The same thing happened to students using several other Asian accents. So, that's where I feel the human component is important. We need to be careful that we don't let AI take over our lives.

I also do not allow generative AI in my classroom. When I ask my children a question, or if they have a question, I will never ask them to Google it. Because the easiest way to kill a love for learning is to find a ready-made answer.

Educationalists and philosophers in the field of education have talked about existing in the liminal space, which is that space where you struggle with a concept, that threshold between not knowing something and struggling with something and then finally learning it. I think that is a beautiful space to be in mentally and we need these as human beings. We need this time and space to reconfigure ourselves, time for ideas to incubate and grow. Relying on technology in that phase would be terrible. While technology should be used as a crutch, it is easy to over-rely on technology and use it as a crutch. If you want to create human beings that make their own contribution in the world, I think there should be serious restrictions on the amount of AI used among kids.

One fear is that AI could harm a student's ability to think and learn for themselves – for instance, if they just enter their homework as a ChatGPT prompt, the AI does their homework for them. Is this a valid fear?

LJ: Yes, this is where we need to take a balanced position. AI can affect children's thinking abilities, but it depends on how we use it. There are two possibilities, one is where the child uses the AI, the AI gives the answer, the child copies it, submits it and moves on. Then we have a problem, as the child is not using his brain.



Children are much more tech savvy and even AI savvy than they were a few years ago. So I don't think bans and restrictions are the solution. It is better to understand artificial intelligence and make our children aware of the pros and cons

LAVINA JASWANI

Instead, we need to guide the child on how to use it and that is where we need to put the restriction.

Suppose you are trying to teach fractions or some kind of problem-solving lesson. If the AI gives the answer, the child misses the struggle, the trial and error, the logical thinking, and the satisfaction of finally getting the answer.

So the rule in my classroom is that first, the child needs to think it, then write it and then lastly, ask the AI to verify the answer. They must try to solve it themselves, but if they can't, just as they may ask their parents or their teacher for help, they can ask AI too to provide assistance in the same way.

DJ: The problem is over-reliance. If you've been driving a manual car and then you shift to an automatic car, you're going to get used to it and to go back to driving manual, right? Similarly, I think you can become over-reliant on someone else doing the work for you or on a device synthesising ideas by just feeding them into an AI tool such as the NotebookLM. The capacity of the human brain is immeasurable. There's so much study that has gone into how brains function, and their neuroplasticity. It would be a shame if we let it. Especially in the primary and elementary years, where so much of growth is happening.

So while it's a great tool, I think we should be very cautious in how it is used.

At the same time, I don't think a complete ban is the answer and a one-year moratorium may not be enough to think through, to plan, and to set up some guardrails around how AI should be used in education.

AI is now an integral part of basic search, of Google, of emails, and even in games. So students are using AI whenever they use the Internet at home. So why keep it out of class?

DJ: AI educators, we don't really have control over what kids are exposed to at home, but the one place where we can still teach critical thinking skills is in the classroom. I think we have to preserve that as far as we can. Also, I think children these days are really good at spotting something that's AI-generated versus the real thing, and for many of them it is not fool anymore.

I feel like we, the older generation, are more

easily fooled when it comes to AI.

LJ: Children are much more tech savvy and even AI savvy than they were a few years ago. So I don't think bans and restrictions are the solution. It is better to understand AI and make our children aware of the pros and cons.

Central and State governments are starting to commission pilot projects using AI tools in government schools and in rural areas where there is a shortage of quality teachers, in the hope that AI can bridge that gap. Could AI supplement or even replace teachers in some of these schools?

LJ: AI should not replace a teacher; it should extend the teacher. Especially in primary education, where children learn best through stories, activities, and conversations – moments that are very important to human relationships. That bond with the teacher is very important. So I would never want AI to become the teacher sitting in front of the children. I see AI as a learning assistant.

DJ: My first job was in a village school and there were times I wished I had more resources and more tools, especially to translate more content and make it accessible. But I agree that you cannot completely do away with teachers just because knowledge can be found anywhere. But if you think of schools as not just knowledge centres, but wisdom centres where you learn from other human beings about how to become a good human, then you need teachers to be present, curating resources for the child.

How have you found AI helpful for teacher preparation and training?

DJ: Prep time is very limited so AI tools really help. If I input what I need to teach into Gemini, it helps me create slide decks that I can then present to the class. But again, we need to be careful because we have learnt through experience that AI can hallucinate and put out wrong information, so teachers do need to double check.

LJ: It can help teachers use different techniques in their classroom. Suppose I am teaching fractions in class and one child understands the concept immediately, but another child is still confused; traditionally, the second child may simply hear the same explanation again, but an AI tool can guide the teacher to teach fractions in a more visual and fun way by using a chocolate and dividing it up.



To listen to the full interview
Scan the code or go to the link
www.thehindu.com

Should the use of Gen AI be banned among younger students in school

Arguments for ban

- **Cognitive Deskilling**
- **Digital Dementia**
- **Algorithmic Homogenization (Echo Chamber Effect)**

Arguments against ban

- **Digital Divide**
- **Prohibition Paradox**
- **Cognitive Offloading (Extended Mind)**
- **Infantilization Effect**

Way ahead : Don't ban it : age-gate and supervise it.

The challenges for BRICS in a changing world order

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EXPERTS EXPLAIN

ANURAG BISAIN &
RAJ KUMAR SHARMA

INDIA is set to host the 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi on September 12 and 13 as the grouping marks 20 years since its formalisation in 2006. This anniversary is an occasion to assess whether BRICS has remained true to the concerns that brought it together, and how it must adapt to a rapidly changing global order.

BRICS vs G7: By the numbers

In 2000, Brazil, Russia, India and China together accounted for roughly 23% of global GDP on a purchasing power parity (PPP) basis, while the G7 held nearly 52%. By 2024, the positions had reversed: the expanded 11-member BRICS accounted for approximately 36.8% of global GDP (PPP), while the G7's share fell below 29%.

BRICS nations are projected to grow at an average 3.8% in 2025 and 3.7% in 2026, more than three times the G7 average. Yet the per-capita GDP tells a different story: the G7 averages around \$53,000, while BRICS averages roughly \$8,200. The bloc's aggregate weight is driven by population and resource scale, not by individual prosperity.

Vision and reality

BRICS began as BRIC — Brazil, Russia, India and China — in 2006, following the Goldman Sachs projection identifying these economies as future engines of global growth. It evolved from a foreign ministers' dialogue into a leaders' forum, with its first summit in Yekaterinburg, Russia, in 2009. South Africa joined in 2010, and the grouping (now known as BRICS) expanded dramatically in 2024 with the addition of Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, Saudi Arabia and the UAE. Indonesia became the 11th full member in January 2025.

What started as an economic grouping has become a geopolitical entity of considerable weight, increasingly perceived itself as a voice of the Global South. Yet its central grievance has changed remarkably little: global institutions have not kept pace with the redistribution of economic and political power. The first summit called for reform of international financial institutions



India's strategic engagement

India's involvement in BRICS reflects its broader strategy of multi-alignment, underpinned by strategic autonomy. New Delhi participates simultaneously in BRICS, the G20, the Quad and the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation without being tied to alliance commitments. BRICS emerged during an early phase of India-US strategic convergence, and India's multi-alignment has been less about choosing between competing power centres and more about creating room for manoeuvre.

India has made substantial institutional contributions. At the 2012 New Delhi summit, India proposed a BRICS development bank, which became the New Development Bank (NDB). By mid-2026, the NDB had approved approximately \$4 billion across 141 projects. India's broader objective has been to shape debates on climate change, sustainable development and trade.

Divergences within BRICS

One of the most significant tensions within BRICS is the fundamental disagreement over its purpose. China and Russia consistently position BRICS as a counterweight to Western dominance, a platform to challenge US-led institutions and the dollar's hegemony. Being has driven the bloc's expansion, viewing a larger BRICS as a vehicle to project leadership of the Global South. Moscow, excluded from the SWIFT banking

BRICS members during the 2025 summit in Rio de Janeiro, Brazil.
WIREIMAGE.COM/SHOVS

India's strategy of autonomy

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system and facing sweeping sanctions, sees BRICS as a critical economic lifeline. India and Brazil, in contrast, view BRICS primarily as an economic and reformed grouping. The divergence was evident when Russia demanded in 2023 that India pay for oil in yuan — India refused, insisting on dollars or rupees only.

On opposing sides: Iran, UAE

BRICS expansion has introduced sharp geopolitical contradictions that test the grouping's cohesion. The most visible fault line emerged at the BRICS Foreign Ministers' meeting in New Delhi in May 2026, when members failed to agree on a joint declaration. The breakdown was driven by a direct confrontation between Iran and the UAE, two member states on opposite sides of an active conflict. India, as host, issued a chair's statement acknowledging "differing views among some members regarding the situation in West Asia". The episode exposed a structural vulnerability: BRICS operates on consensus, and expansion has made consensus on geopolitical crises far more elusive.

The dollar question

Western countries view BRICS with a mixture of concern and pragmatism, recognising it not as an immediate replacement for the existing international order, but as a platform capable of gradually reshaping the distribution of geopolitical power.

The sharpest clash has come with US President Donald Trump, who has threatened 100% tariffs on BRICS nations if they created a new currency or backed

20 years on, BRICS has emerged as a key global voice. But its expansion and evolving geopolitics have sharpened the faultlines over its direction

any other currency to replace the US dollar. The idea of a single BRICS currency has largely been shelved.

BRICS members have instead gravitated towards bilateral settlement of trade in national currencies, a more pragmatic, decentralised approach. Russia and China now settle over 90% of their bilateral trade in ruble and yuan. Russia and India have moved roughly 90% of direct payments to national currencies, facilitated by Special Rupee Vostro Accounts authorised by the Reserve Bank of India. India and the UAE have operated a rupee-dirham local currency settlement system since July 2023 while India and Indonesia operationalised a rupee-rupiah settlement framework in July 2026.

The BRICS Pay system, set to be unveiled at the 2026 summit, will link national payment rails — Russia's SPFS, China's CIPS, India's UPI and Brazil's Pix — allowing member states to settle trade without routing through dollar correspondent banks. This is "de-dollarisation" through the back door. India's approach has been to push for interoperable central bank digital currencies (CBDCs) rather than a supranational currency.

Yet the limitations are real: the dollar still accounts for 57.18% of global central bank reserves (Q1 2026), so no BRICS member is building rupee, yuan or rand reserves at meaningful scale.

India's priorities

At host of the 2026 summit, India faces a demanding agenda. The conflicts involving Iran, Israel and the US, as well as the Russia-Ukraine war, will test India's ability to build consensus on a joint declaration. Chinese President Xi Jinping's visit to India and the UAE, two member states on opposite sides of an active conflict, could create opportunities for high-level consultations.

Beyond geopolitics, the summit will focus on practical cooperation: resilient and diversified supply chains, reform of global financial institutions, strengthening the NDB and expanding intra-BRICS trade.

Over the next decade, India can contribute by preserving BRICS' original reform agenda while making the grouping more practical. Digital public infrastructure, climate finance, health cooperation, critical minerals, local currency payments and inclusive connectivity can gain BRICS a concrete developmental agenda.

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The challenges for BRICS in a changing world order

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Growth Spurt

Growth spurt

Alternative powertrains are now mainstream in automobiles

According to data released by the Federation of Automobile Dealers' Associations (FADA), total vehicle registrations in August have increased 17.5% year on year, recording the all-time highest volume for the month, and with alternative powertrains, i.e., CNG, electric, and hybrids, leading passenger vehicle sales for the first time. But upon a closer look, some confounding factors emerge that also warrant caution about the figures. First, July 2026 itself was a strong month, with the August numbers 6.4% lower, possibly due to the monsoon. Second, the number of vehicles retailed in rural areas grew 19.7% year on year over 15.1% in urban areas; passenger vehicles sales likewise increased 24.9% in rural areas versus 10.9% in urban areas. This could be due to rising disposable incomes and consistent state capital expenditure on semi-urban infrastructure. However, tractor sales have in the past indicated monsoon-related rural stress, and while their sales are virtually unchanged year on year, they declined 25% month on month. Together with two-wheelers and passenger vehicles selling well, the trend suggests that non-farm rural incomes and mobility could be strengthening more than capital spending linked to agriculture. Third, last year, the GST Council reduced taxes on small cars, motorcycles (up to 350 cc), three-wheelers, buses, and goods vehicles, so August 2025 sales growth dropped as buyers waited for the new rates from September. Fourth, while CNG, hybrid, and electric powertrains beat petrol/ethanol vehicle sales by 1.1 percentage points, most hybrid vehicles still burn petrol while CNG itself is a fossil fuel. So the lead taken by alternative powertrains is not synonymous with a lead of non-fossil-fuel vehicles.

That said, petrol vehicles falling behind is still notable; the data also show that between August 2024 and August 2026, CNG and electric powertrains contributed most of the surge, implying that Indians are switching to alternatives that are cheaper to run, in light of the West Asia conflict and, to a lesser degree, concerns over ethanol blending. Next, the move away from petrol is uneven: three-wheelers are predominantly electric while two-wheelers catch up, and passenger cars' powertrains continue to diversify. And electrification continues to reflect rising consumer demand as much as industrial policy. Finally, FADA also reported that, despite record sales, dealers are holding 38-40 days of inventory against the recommended 21. So while the petrol era is far from over, the Indian automotive industry has commenced the mass-market integration of alternative powertrains. But that said, only if September-November preserves the gains in alternative powertrains after the base effect disappears, and dealer inventories return to normal levels, can August 2026 be considered a historic moment.

Growth Spurt

The powertrain decides how a car is powered and how efficiently that power is used.

It could be

- 1. Internal combustion engine (ICE) powertrains**
- 2. Hybrid powertrain : These combine an internal combustion engine with an electric motor and battery.**
- 3. Electric vehicle (EV) powertrain : Uses only an electric motor and battery**
- 4. Emerging and alternative powertrains : Flex-fuel engines (ethanol-petrol blends) and Hydrogen fuel cell (long-term, still limited in India)**

Growth Spurt

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Question

GS

Medium

Prelims 2025

Science & Technology

Consider the following types of vehicles:

I. Full battery electric vehicles

II. Hydrogen fuel cell vehicles

III. Fuel cell electric hybrid vehicles

How many of the above are considered as alternative (powertrain) vehicles?

A Only one

B Only two

C All the three

D None

Thank You